

11 Outward Charges Schools Made Against Social-Media Platforms

Web-only source table. This table organizes the pleaded outward allegations from the consolidated school/local-government complaint against Meta/Facebook/Instagram, Google/YouTube, Snap, TikTok/ByteDance, and related defendants. The complaint itself pleads two formal legal causes of action: public nuisance and negligence. The 11 entries below are the specific pleaded allegation categories underneath those counts.

#	Pleaded outward charge	What schools alleged	Demand-formation translation	Complaint anchor
1	Targeting school-aged children as a core market	The schools alleged the platforms targeted minors as a growth pipeline and monetized youth attention through advertising and engagement.	Children were treated as future users, attention inventory, and data/ad value, not as a protected compulsory-school population.	TOC Sec. IV.A.1; Intro paras. 7, 13-14
2	Children uniquely susceptible to platform harm	The complaint alleges minors' developing brains make them more vulnerable to addictive design and resulting harm than adults.	This is the child-capacity point: the burden cannot be assigned to child willpower.	TOC Sec. IV.A.2; Intro paras. 8-12
3	Automated recommendation systems fueling addictive use	The schools alleged algorithmic recommendation systems, feeds, and content-agnostic engagement loops drove compulsive use by children.	The demand pathway is not random use; it is engineered capture and retention.	TOC Sec. IV.A.3; YouTube/Google Sec. E.3.c
4	Psychological manipulation and engagement design	The complaint points to endless scroll, intermittent variable rewards, notifications, likes, filters, streaks, autoplay, and other features used to keep minors hooked.	The design trains attention, reward, comparison, and return behavior.	Intro paras. 8-10; para. 107 lead-in; Meta/Snap/TikTok/YouTube sections
5	Weak age verification, parental controls, and default safeguards	The schools alleged inadequate age checks, ineffective parental oversight, lack of default limits, and barriers to account deletion or deactivation.	The platforms kept the pathway open while making exit and adult protection weaker.	Intro para. 8; TikTok Sec. D.4.a-b; Google Sec. E.3.a
6	Illegal harvesting and monetization of children's data	The complaint alleges children's data was harvested and used to fuel targeting, recommendations, and ad sales.	The child becomes data supply and ad-value material.	TOC Sec. IV.A.5; Intro para. 14
7	Youth mental health crisis	The schools alleged platform design contributed to depression, anxiety, eating disorders, self-harm, suicidality, loneliness, and other harms.	Cost appears later as child harm and public-school burden, after value was extracted upstream.	TOC Sec. IV.A.6; paras. 161-177
8	Dangerous challenges and harmful behavior spread through platforms	The complaint alleged platforms encouraged dangerous challenges and other harmful conduct that schools had to address.	The pathway creates school-day behavioral and safety costs after platforms collect the engagement value.	TOC Sec. IV.A.7; school-harm sections
9	Resource diversion and operational harm to schools	The schools alleged they had to spend more on counselors, staff, discipline, phone confiscation, parent communication, safety responses, learning supports, and revised teaching methods.	This is the burden-transfer claim: schools alleged platform-created costs landed inside public education.	Intro paras. 1-6; paras. 247-251, 973
10	Child sexual exploitation, sextortion, and CSAM failures	The complaint alleged platforms failed to implement safety features to limit and prevent child sexual exploitation, sextortion, and distribution of known CSAM; it separately alleged Meta and Google/YouTube facilitated CSAM/child exploitation risks.	This is the non-optional stop-command category: child exploitation is not a side issue; it is pleaded as platform-enabled harm.	Para. 107; Meta Sec. B.5/para. 548; Google Sec. E.4/paras. 947-954
11	Failure to warn, concealment, and failure to provide safe-use instructions	The complaint alleged platforms failed to warn schools, parents, youth, and the public about known risks, and failed to provide safe-use instructions; Meta is alleged to have concealed harmful effects from the public and Congress.	The owner-function kept knowledge upstream while schools and children absorbed downstream costs.	Meta Sec. B.4 and B.6; Google Sec. E.5; para. 965

Sources used: Plaintiffs' Master Complaint (Local Government and School District), In re Social Media Adolescent Addiction/Personal Injury Products Liability Litigation, MDL No. 3047, Doc. 504, filed Dec. 18, 2023; JPML transfer materials for centralized school-district claims; Tech Policy Press tracker for procedural status and defendant set. The highlighted row is the child sexual exploitation / sextortion / CSAM charge category.